

Quiz 2- Code of Conducts

1. A disciplinary code of conduct has the following objective:

- a) To ensure that the behavior of all professionals or employees meets certain values and norms.
- b) To state to the outside world the kind of values the profession or company is committed to.
- c) To ensure that all technologies developed by a company are screened for possibly dangerous errors.
- d) To ensure that a company meets the legal requirements of a country.

2. What is the function of an aspirational professional code?

- a) Such a code specifies the ideals that are regarded as worth pursuing in a given professional group.
- b) Such a code prevents abuses in professional practice.
- c) Such a code functions as the basis for disciplinary proceedings within the professional group.
- d) Such a code gives guidelines for action to professionals.

3. Corporate codes of conduct are often more effective in encouraging ethical behavior than professional codes because:

- a) external entities can criticize a company for not living according to its corporate codes
- b) enforcement of corporate codes is always strict
- c) professional codes are usually controversial
- d) professional codes, but not corporate codes are legally binding

4. A number of objections have been raised against codes of conduct. Which objection does not apply to aspirational and advisory codes?

- a) Code of conduct sometimes amount to window-dressing;
- b) Codes of conduct are often vague and are potentially contradictory;
- c) Ethics cannot be codified;
- d) Codes of conduct cannot be lived by;
- e) Codes of conduct are not enforced.

5. The next three questions are about the IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers) Code of Ethics. This code reads as follows:

1. We, the members of the IEEE, in recognition of the importance of our technologies in affecting the quality of life throughout the world, and in accepting a personal obligation to our profession, its members and the communities we serve, do hereby commit ourselves to the highest ethical and professional conduct and agree:

2. to accept responsibility in making decisions consistent with the safety, health, and welfare of the public, and to disclose promptly factors that might endanger the public or the environment;

3. to avoid real or perceived conflicts of interest whenever possible, and to disclose them to affected parties when they do exist;

4. to be honest and realistic in stating claims or estimates based on available data;

5. to reject bribery in all its forms;

6. to improve the understanding of technology; its' appropriate application, and potential consequences;

7. to maintain and improve our technical competence and to undertake technological tasks

for others only if qualified by training or experience, or after full disclosure of pertinent limitations;

8. to seek, accept, and offer honest criticism of technical work, to acknowledge and correct errors, and to credit properly the contributions of others;
9. to treat fairly all persons and to not engage in acts of discrimination based on race, religion, gender, disability, age, national origin, sexual orientation, gender identity, or gender expression;
10. to avoid injuring others, their property, reputation, or employment by false or malicious action;
11. to assist colleagues and co-workers in their professional development and to support them in following this code of ethics.

Most of the professional codes for engineers stress the duty of engineers to serve the public interest. Which of the 10 Articles phrases this in the IEEE Code of Ethics?

- a) Article 2
- b) Article 9
- c) Article 1
- d) Article 8

6. Which three Articles are especially related to integrity and competent professional practice?

- a) Article 6
- b) Article 8
- c) Article 1
- d) Article 2
- e) Article 7

7. Article 5 of the IEEE Code of Ethics is especially related to the domain of

- a. social responsibility and obligations towards the public.
- b. integrity and competent professional practice
- c. obligations towards clients and employers

8. Which of the following situations is an example of a conflict of interest?

- a) Nary wants to inform the public about a health risk caused by a subcontractor that she works with, but from a legal point of view she is required to keep this information confidential.
- b) Nary is designing the wheels for a new model of train, and she is trying to weigh the values of safety versus passenger comfort within the design.
- c) Nary has determined that her company has exceeded the pollution limits set by law, and on behalf of the company she wishes to compensate those who have been affected.
- d) All of the above.

9. The Mekong Corporation is unhappy with Sok's behavior. They argue that when Sok joined the corporation, he committed to the corporation's Code of Conduct, which stresses the values of confidentiality and loyalty. They claim that Sok has behaved immorally and disloyally by making certain test results public. Which of the following arguments is Sok's best defense against this claim?

- a) Loyalty does not mean that the interests of the employer have to be placed above all other considerations.
- b) The Mekong Code of Conduct conflicts with Sok's religious belief.
- c) Corporate codes of conduct exist to raise awareness of moral values, not to prescribe concrete moral judgments.
- d) The potential loss of human lives trumps all other considerations in moral decision-making.
- e) Sok has a duty to always tell the truth and not lie about any test results.